

Ben Fennell

IT Support Specialist · DTS Desktop Services, Curtin University

23 Oldham Pass, High Wycombe WA 6057 · 0432 979 747 · ben.fennell@curtin.edu.au

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with a decade of progressive experience across the full Curtin University IT asset lifecycle: Deployment, Service Desk, and Desktop Services. Designs and delivers production PowerShell / WPF tooling deployed via Intune to internal teams. Hands-on across Active Directory, Microsoft 365, Exchange Online, Intune endpoint management, and modern self-hosted infrastructure. Currently moving into enterprise systems administration, with platform breadth being built through both internal delivery and a continuously expanding home lab.

KEY TECHNICAL SKILLS

Microsoft 365 / Exchange Online: Mailbox administration, calendar processing, room and shared mailbox provisioning, bulk remediation via the EXO PowerShell module, MAPI corruption diagnosis, automapping remediation, distribution list to cloud-managed group migration design

Active Directory: Cross-forest administration of staff.ad.curtin.edu.au and student.ad.curtin.edu.au, PRIV and security group management, ACL audit and remediation

PowerShell: WPF GUI development, modular module design with dot-sourced event handlers, Start-Job and ThreadJob delegation, ps2exe packaging

Intune & Endpoint Management: Win32 app authoring with versioned detection rules, package versioning workflow, install/uninstall/detect scripts, first-time-setup wizards with auto-elevation, IntuneWinAppUtil; MD-102 certified

Scripting & Programming: PowerShell, Python, C, Arduino C++, SQL, basic Linux administration

Self-hosted Infrastructure: VM administration (UTM, HAOS), Docker / OrbStack container orchestration, Tailscale mesh networking with HTTPS certificates and subnet routing, AdGuard Home DNS filtering, reverse-proxy trust and TLS termination, Uptime Kuma monitoring, NoMachine remote desktop

Service Management: ITIL-aligned workflows, ServiceNow, Agile / Scrum ceremonies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Support Specialist · Curtin University · DTS Desktop Services

Mar 2022 – Present

- Acts as the L2 escalation point for the Service Desk on complex Microsoft 365, Active Directory, and endpoint issues.
- Administers Exchange Online: shared and room mailbox provisioning, calendar processing, mailbox and calendar permissions, mail-flow restrictions.
- Manages Active Directory permissions across PRIV groups, security groups, and folder ACLs on the network drives.
- Investigates complex mailbox issues including MAPI corruption, automapping anomalies, and OST recreation.
- Authors and maintains Knowledge Articles consumed by the wider DTS support function.

IT Support Officer · Curtin University · Service Desk

May 2020 – Mar 2022

- First point of contact for staff and student IT issues across the full Microsoft and Curtin-bespoke estate.
- Maintained broad knowledge of DTS support areas for accurate triage and escalation of tickets across specialist teams.
- Authored and maintained Knowledge Articles used by the wider DTS support function.
- Worked within ITIL-aligned ticket workflows in ServiceNow.

IT Deployment Officer · Curtin University

Oct 2016 – May 2020

- Deployed PCs and peripherals to clients across the Bentley campus, undertaking imaging, reimaging, and user data migration.
- Liaised with clients and coordinated scheduling across multiple Deployment Officers' workloads.
- Developed the institutional knowledge of Curtin's endpoint estate that has underpinned every role since.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AdminForge A PowerShell WPF application deployed via Intune. Four production tabs cover meeting room permissions, AD group comparison, PRIV group management, and file ACL administration.

Power Grid A multi-view HTML performance dashboard with radar charts, per-technician detail pages, sortable ranking sidebar, monthly rolling trend charts, and a collapsible metric explainer.

Home Lab Infrastructure Multi-service self-hosted stack on a single host. Home Assistant in a UTM VM, plus containerised Immich, Vaultwarden, AdGuard Home, and Homepage under OrbStack. Tailscale mesh networking provides three layers of off-LAN access (tailscale serve for HTTPS-terminated tailnet hostnames, subnet routing, and direct tailnet-IP) with HTTPS certificates and MagicDNS enabled. Uptime Kuma monitoring.

ESP32 / Embedded Systems Self-directed study of embedded electronics and Arduino C++ via a Freenove ESP32-S3 starter kit. Working through GPIO, strapping pins, pull-up/pull-down resistor topology, current limiting, switch debounce, and the Arduino preprocessor model, with a current goal of building a rat-ratgdo board to control my Chamberlain garage door locally.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **Google Cybersecurity Certificate** · Coursera, October 2025 (threat detection, log analysis, incident response fundamentals)
- **CS50x: Introduction to Computer Science** · Harvard via edX, September 2025 (C, Python, SQL, algorithms, networking, secure software practices)
- **Microsoft Certified: Microsoft 365 Endpoint Administrator (MD-102T00)** · Lumify Work Australia, September 2023
- **Scrum Master** · DDLS, July 2021